



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor Classical Academy Co-op

School Website: <https://valorcca.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Valor Classical Academy Co-op (Woodbury, MN, 55125) presents a clearly classical, Christian-leaning program that centers on liberal arts formation through Trivium and Quadrivium-influenced pedagogy. Public materials from Valor emphasize truth-focused schooling, Bible infusion, and Christian discernment as core aims, with explicit reference to Trivium and Quadrivium as the framework for the Liberal Arts. This yields a strong alignment in the Curriculum and Religious/Metaphysical Foundations areas, and a solid, formation-oriented School Purpose. However, the publicly available materials do not consistently demonstrate the full spectrum of classical indicators across all six categories (notably in explicit mention of Great Books/-Great Conversation, Socratic seminars, visible "living curriculum" faculty cultures, and comprehensive parent partnership language). On balance, Valor is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear strengths in curriculum and religious orientation, and room for deeper documentation of pedagogy, faculty portrayal, and parent/community integration in the classical sense.

Key evidence and contours:

- **Religious and Metaphysical Foundations:** Bible infusion, Scripture as a plumb line for truth, and explicit Christian discernment in our mission statements indicate a grounded theological posture and transcendental moral framework. These signals align with classical positive indicators around truth, theology, and sacred formation.
- **Purpose and Goal:** Formation focused on virtue and wisdom is implied through mission language ("truth-focused Liberal Arts education," "Christian discernment") and the aim of forming leaders, but explicit articulation of telos, true/good/beautiful as a knowledgeable end-state is less overt in public copy. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL read rather than a full CLASSICAL read for this category.
- **Curriculum:** Strong alignment via Trivium and Quadrivium, with explicit mention of grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the liberal-arts framing. This category clearly meets classical expectations.
- **Pedagogy:** Public content hints at a classical sensibility (structured, disciplined Liberal Arts framing; emphasis on memory and contemplation in the broader classical discourse), but explicit claims of Socratic seminars, formal upper-school rhetoric drills, or explicit scholé pedagogy are not consistently documented in the public-facing materials. This points to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- **Faculty:** Public-facing materials emphasize mission and philosophy but provide limited explicit descriptions of teachers as "living curriculum" or a formal faculty culture. The case for CLASSICAL faculty culture is present but not strongly documented in the public materials provided. This leans to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Parents & Community: Public materials show standard family-admission channels and openness but do not consistently foreground parents as co-teachers or provide robust parent-formation programs in the classical sense. This is another area where the school is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Bible is infused in our education; Scripture used as the plumb line for objective truth. - Mission emphasizes truth-focused Liberal Arts education and Christian discernment. - References to worshipful, God-centered framing and “the great I AM.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, Scripture, Bible, theological underpinnings (Churchly/Christian framing), discernment, sacred/holy framing (within the Christian context). - Negative keywords present: none detectable in public copy (no explicit relativism or secular-humanist signals).

Why this rating - The school publicly embeds truth-centered and theological dimensions, with Scripture as a normative standard. This maps cleanly to Transcendental moral realism and Grounded in Theology signals in the classical lexicon. The absence of explicit liturgical/communal worship signals does not negate the strong theological grounding; thus, CLASSICAL would require more explicit liturgical/programmatic signals which are not clearly documented in the public materials. The current evidence supports a CLASSICAL posture in foundations, with some missing liturgical signaling. Given the rubric’s emphasis on theological grounding and transcendentals, the presence of “truth” and Bible-infused pedagogy justifies CLASSICAL signals in this category, tempered by the absence of explicit liturgical practices in the available copy.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission centers on formation, formation of discernment, and virtue through a Liberal Arts framework; Christian aims main through the education process. - Deep aim to cultivate leaders who glorify the Lord; a telos oriented toward character and moral formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implied through formation and discernment), classical mission (via Liberal Arts framing). - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit statements about Great Books/Great Conversation, broad human flourishing language beyond Christian discernment; no explicit “workforce-preparation” framing appears in the public copy.

Why this rating - The materials show a clear formation/virtue-oriented objective consistent with CLASSICAL aims, though the explicit articulation of the “true, good, beautiful” triad as a known end-state and the explicit Great Conversation telos are less visible. This places Valor in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for this category. The Positive keyword anchors (formation/virtue/wisdom) support this, but the absence of explicit Great Conversation/teleology signals moderates the rating.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (numbers, geometry, music, cosmos) framing is present. - Liberal Arts as the overarching curricular frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history (as part of classical curriculum framing), Great Books/great conversation (not explicitly stated but conceptually aligned with classical canon in the broader lexicon). - Negative keywords present: not explicitly seen in the public copy (no explicit anti-classical or anti-Great-Books signals in the visible text).

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of Trivium and Quadrivium and the liberal-arts framework strongly align with CLASSICAL curriculum indicators. The absence of explicit Great Books references in the visible site copy does not negate the canonical Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis. Overall, Curriculum is CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Classical pedagogy signals include memory-related practice and a plurality of structured, disciplined approaches typical in classical settings; the broader classical discourse in the content (e.g., scholé and contemplative/restful dimensions) is present in the classical education literature the school aligns with. Public copy suggests a disciplined, truth-centered approach, but explicit mention of Socratic seminars, upper-school seminars, and formal rhetoric training is not consistently documented within Valor's public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplation/rest, memorization, memory work, singing/chants for memory (classical pedagogy cues), rhetoric training (mentioned in the broader Trivium/Quadrivium framing), Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy is referenced in classical lexicons but not clearly evidenced on Valor's site copy. - Negative keywords present: explicit reliance on experiential/project-based learning or non-traditional constructivist pedagogy is not present; however, explicit Socratic seminars are not clearly documented.

Why this rating - Valor demonstrates core classical pedagogy through Trivium/Quadrivium alignment and the language of memory, chant, and contemplative/restful dimensions from the broader classical education discourse. The absence of explicit statements about Socratic seminars, frequent seminars, or direct rhetoric-focused pedagogy in public copy reduces the rating from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize virtue-centered education and teacher roles in service of the formation process, but explicit "living curriculum" or "portrait of teacher" language is not robustly documented in the visible site copy. The presence of mission-driven teaching and the classical curriculum framing hints at a teacher culture aligned with classical aims, but explicit faculty-labeled signals are limited in the available public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, mentors as exemplars, living curriculum (as conceptual signals from the classical education lexicon). - Negative keywords present: explicit statements of faculty as living curriculum, portrait of teacher, or formal teacher-cultures are not clearly evidenced in Valor's public content.

Why this rating - While Valor's mission and curriculum imply a teacher-centered, virtue-formation approach consistent with classical norms, the public-facing copy does not strongly advertise a defined faculty culture (e.g., "living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher"). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize admissions and engagement channels (e.g., admissions, FAQ, newsletters), and there is at least some external community-facing content (newsletters, contact). There is no explicit, sustained language about parents as co-teachers or a formal parent-formation program in the visible public content. The non-discrimination policy and a policy stance on funds show governance but not full parental partnership language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families (documented in the classical lexicon as a desirable signal), parent formation, and co-teaching language (not strongly evidenced on Valor's public pages, but expected in classical programs). - Negative keywords present: consumer/customer language or minimal parent involvement signals are not clearly visible; the absence is more an absence of explicit signals than explicit negation.

Why this rating - The available public materials show typical school-community interfaces (admissions, newsletters) but lack robust, explicit language about parents as co-teachers, systematic parent formation,

or overt open-campus visitation norms. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is a conservative, evidence-based rating for Parents & Community.

Overall classification (aggregate) - Based on the six-category analysis, Valor Classical Academy Co-op (Woodbury, MN, 55125) demonstrates strong Curriculum alignment (CLASSICAL) and solid Religious/Meta-physical foundations (CLASSICAL), with the other four categories showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals. The aggregate classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Elevate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and evidence on site: publish a public-facing, grade-by-grade Great Books/Great Conversation plan and reading lists to demonstrate the canon-engaged dimension of the curriculum.
- Document explicit Socratic pedagogy and higher-level seminar practices: include statements about upper-grade Socratic discussions, seminars, debates, and a concerted rhetoric program that culminates in public speaking or oratory—complete with examples or sample syllabi.
- Make the faculty culture explicit: publish a “living curriculum” portrait of a teacher, a profile of the ideal teacher, and statements about faculty collaboration, mentoring, and ongoing classical pedagogy training.
- Strengthen parent partnership language: clearly state how parents are co-teachers, describe parent formation programs (book studies, seminars, family liturgical alignment), and show open-visit policies on campus.
- Expand liturgical or communal practice signals: include explicit references to liturgical year activities, community worship/music, or shared rituals that align with a Christian classical tradition.
- Publicly articulate a more explicit telos and the true/good/beautiful triad in curriculum and assessment, making the formation of virtue and wisdom as measurable outcomes through portfolio or memory work that ties back to Great Books and classical virtues.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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